



Backyard Expedition

Four things to do outside with your kid. A backyard works. So does a park, a balcony or the end of the street. None of it needs equipment and none of it needs you to be good at drawing. Doing it next to each other is the whole point.

ONE

Draw what you see

Both of you pick the same thing and draw it. A tree, a bug, the view. Then swap and look at what the other one noticed.

There are no wrong answers on a drawing page.

THREE

Spot ten things

Tick them off as you find them. Take turns spotting. No prizes.

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| ☐ A bird | ☐ A bug |
| ☐ Something green | ☐ A cloud |
| ☐ Something the wind is moving | ☐ A leaf with a hole in it |
| ☐ Something smaller than your thumbnail | ☐ A sound you cannot see |
| ☐ Something older than you | ☐ Something you never noticed before |

TWO

Read a bit, outside

Bring whatever book is already going. Sit somewhere and read. You can read to them, they can read to you, or you can each read your own thing in the same patch of grass.

THE BOOK WE BROUGHT

THE BEST BIT

WHERE WE SAT

FOUR

One slow breath

Charlotte does this in the story whenever things go wrong. It is the breathe part of **Stop. Breathe. Think. Act.**

- 1 Sit down together. Both of you close your eyes.
- 2 Breathe in slowly while you count to four.
- 3 Breathe out slowly while you count to four.
- 4 Do it three times. Then talk about how your body feels.

ASK EACH OTHER: WHEN IS A GOOD TIME TO USE THIS?

FOR GROWN-UPS The breathing steps are the ones printed in the Adventures of Charlotte and Henry activity pages, and Charlotte takes a slow breath twice in *Mount Everest*. The spotting list is deliberately generic so it works anywhere, in any season, in any country. The free **Stop. Breathe. Think. Act.** poster is on the same page this came from.